

200 YEARS OF WOMEN'S HATS

Towards the end of the 18th century wide, flat shepherdess hats were popular, being overtaken in the early 1800s by bonnets, which remained fashionable for decades. Hat styles during the Victorian and Edwardian eras were extremely varied, ranging from small toques to huge confections of flowers, feathers, and even entire birds. Until well into the 20th century most women, regardless of social status, did not think of leaving the house without a hat. Today millinery has a place in high fashion, with hat designers pushing creative boundaries to ever greater levels of innovation and drama.



1800 Shepherdess hat with silk crown and flat straw brim



c. 1880 Velvet hat in bottle-green, trimmed with a gold and green patterned grosgrain (ribbed) ribbon, and cream and black feathers



1896 Blue bonnet of silk-covered straw, trimmed with black ostrich feathers



c. 1910 Straw hat with wide brim, velvet facing, and silk rose decoration around the crown



1916–18 Summer hat made from cream-coloured embroidered net, decorated with two silk flowers and lined in silk



1940s Black felt hat trimmed with a wide satin ribbon and feather in the brim



1940s Velour hat in burgundy, with turned-up brim and felt flowers



1941 Crêpe hat in blue, with leaf and berry decoration



1950s Velvet hat with a net veil and decorative beading



1960 Round hat of pale pink silk with an upturned scalloped brim, by Givenchy



c. 1965 Soft cap by Simone Mirman, with panels of white leather and striped jersey



1970s Summer hat of cream-coloured linen with brown floral appliqué patches and lining



1970s Baker boy cap of turquoise crushed velvet, with peak and button trim